Alexander Prins

Brand Designer

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Des Moines, IA
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Translating complexity into simplicity with brand, motion, code and systems.

Experience

Shift Nudge — Creative Editor, Motion & Video

Remote · 2025–Present

- Growing the brand's audience **more than 2x, from ~40K to 88K+** followers and climbing, and have driven **2.2M+ total views** and counting with a consistent, systematic content engine
- Building repeatable content formats and Instagram-to-email funnels that have added **16,500+ email subscribers** to date
- Own the full production pipeline end to end: co-scripting with the founder, storyboarding, animating, editing, and publishing across Instagram, YouTube, TikTok, LinkedIn, and Threads
- Produce the brand's thought-leadership content, from Config talk clips to podcast features, and edited its 20-lesson **"Claude Code for Designers"** course

Independent Brand & Motion Designer — Freelance

2019–Present

- Design complete brand identities and build the websites they live on, taking clients from positioning, logo, type, color, and voice through to a shipped, on-brand site
- Worked with **30+ clients** across industries including ophthalmology, hospitality, finance, pharmaceuticals, consumer goods, and design education (from Campari to early-stage startups)
- Designed and shipped my own site in code (Next.js, Tailwind) with custom interactive motion
- Design and build brand identities and websites using the right mix of no-code and code tools (Framer, Claude Code) for each client's needs

Northern Vessel — Co-Founder & Brand Designer

Des Moines, IA · 2020–2023

- Co-founded a specialty coffee company, raised **$300K**, opened a flagship shop, and shipped a subscription app
- Built the entire visual identity and brand system from scratch: logo system, packaging, labels, glassware, signage, menus, merchandise, and social and ad creative
- Led design and delivery of the **Coffee Club subscription app** — the metro's first for a coffee shop — from concept to market in 5 months with a 3-person team, including the brand, launch assets, and co-designed UI
- Owned brand direction and marketing strategy for both the shop and the app, plus the launch campaign that drove local and national press (including a **Yahoo News feature**) and a flagship opening at **2x revenue projections**, sustained through my tenure
- Grew the subscription to ~160 active users across 900 accounts (subscribers spending **1.9x more** than non-members) and the brand's social audience **7x, to 7,000+** followers

Des Moines Does Things — Creative Manager

Des Moines, IA · 2021–2022

- Managed creative content and social strategy for **5 bar and hospitality brands**, producing cocktail photography, videography, and social content
- Expanded from content into brand design over the tenure, creating identities for **15+ new concepts, pop-ups, and activations**, along with menus and merchandise across the group's venues

Education

Colorado School of Lutherie — Guitar Building Apprenticeship — Colorado · 2019

University of Colorado Denver — Music Business, Recording Arts & Entrepreneurship — Colorado · 2016–2018

Front Range Community College — Colorado · 2014–2016

Earlier Experience

St. Kilda — Bar Manager — Des Moines, IA · 2019–2020

Bonefish Grill — Dishwasher to Head Waiter — Broomfield, CO · 2016–2019

Earlier service & hospitality — District 36, Panera Bread, Colorado Swim School, and lifeguard & swim instructor for the City of Broomfield — 2011–2019

Skills

Brand design · Web design · Landing pages · Interaction design · Prototyping · Motion design

Tools

Figma Suite · Framer · Claude Code · Cursor · Vercel · GitHub · Spline · Final Cut Pro